

NDA Exam Overview

NDA

Introduction to NDA Exam

The National Defence Academy (NDA) exam is a national-level entrance examination conducted by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) for admission to the Army, Navy, and Air Force wings of the NDA. The exam is held twice a year, typically in April and September, and is a gateway for aspirants to join the Indian Armed Forces. The NDA exam consists of a written examination followed by a Service Selection Board (SSB) interview for candidates who clear the written exam.

Written Examination

The written examination is a multiple-choice question (MCQ) based test that consists of two papers: Mathematics and General Ability Test (GAT). The Mathematics paper is of 300 marks and comprises 120 questions, while the GAT paper is of 600 marks and comprises 150 questions. The exam is of 2 hours and 30 minutes duration for each paper, and the questions are designed to test the candidate's knowledge, reasoning, and analytical skills.

- The Mathematics paper covers topics such as algebra, trigonometry, geometry, and statistics.
- The GAT paper covers topics such as English, general knowledge, physics, chemistry, and current events.

Service Selection Board (SSB) Interview

Candidates who clear the written examination are called for the SSB interview, which is a five-day process that assesses a candidate's personality, intelligence, and suitability for a career in the Armed Forces. The SSB interview consists of several tests and interviews, including:

- Psychological tests, such as thematic appreciation test (TAT), word association test (WAT), and situation reaction test (SRT)
- Group discussions and group planning exercises
- Personal interview with a panel of officers
- Physical and medical tests to assess the candidate's fitness and health

The SSB interview is designed to test a candidate's leadership skills, communication skills, and ability to work in a team, as well as their physical and mental toughness. Candidates who clear the SSB interview are then recommended for admission to the NDA, subject to medical fitness and other requirements.

Preparation and Eligibility

To be eligible for the NDA exam, candidates must be between 16.5 and 19.5 years of age, and must have completed their 12th standard or equivalent examination. Candidates can apply for the exam online, and must submit their application form along with the required fee and documents.

- The exam pattern and syllabus are available on the UPSC website, and candidates can prepare for the exam by studying the prescribed textbooks and reference materials.
- Candidates can also join coaching classes or online courses to help them prepare for the exam and the SSB interview.

The NDA exam is a challenging and competitive exam, and candidates must be well-prepared and focused to succeed. With dedication and hard work, candidates can crack the NDA exam and join the prestigious National Defence Academy.